

M2 - Philosophical and Psychological Perspectives on the Self

1. Defining Your Personal Philosophy

Think of a defining moment in your life that shaped your current beliefs about how to live. What happened, and what did you learn from it? If you had to express your philosophy in a single sentence, what would it be? Can you relate it to any of the philosophers discussed in class, not just in theory but in how you apply it to your life?

At this moment, I don't believe there to be a defining moment so extreme that it shaped my beliefs about how to live. My main belief was built and shaped through many experiences, so I refuse to say that I can be defined by a single moment. Through multiple meaningful moments, be it good or bad, I've come to appreciate them and concluded that my great purpose in life is to experience. I also don't recall relating to any of the philosophers but I've had my fair share of pondering existence so I can relate in that sense.

2. Your Present and Future Self

Write a letter to your future self, ten years from now. How would you describe the person you are today—your personality, strengths, struggles, and dreams? What advice or reminders would you give to your future self about the kind of person you hope to become? Be specific about the experiences, choices, and values that will shape your journey.

I think I've found myself in a place where I still have so many options with what to do with my life and I'm glad I'm put in a position to be uncertain about my future. I think I'd still be in college for some random degree because I think I'd constantly be going to college for the rest of my life. And I really hope to become a wise sage that just knows about a bunch of things and does a bunch of things. Opportunities are rare so I'd hope that I take every single one I'm interested in. I'd want to be extraordinary at least one of the things I like doing so it's just hopes of becoming either an athlete, game developer, youtuber, dancer, or even a musician. I know that there isn't a clear path to any one of those so I'll just always believe that whatever one I choose is the right choice because it was my own.

3. Aligning Your Real and Ideal Self

Assess your real self and ideal self. Are they aligned or different? If different, what personal habits, decisions, or mindset shifts could help bridge the gap? Share a real-life experience that illustrates your growth in this aspect.

Currently, my ideal self is a student-athlete with top-notch grades. My real self is not too far from that, but I need so much more discipline. I'd like to be able to do sports and compete while maintaining good grades. Right now, I have my schedule to train once a week and to do school work during school days. In terms of being an athlete I lack effort, training once a week is not enough for me to win tournaments any time soon. As a student I still lack both discipline and effort, however, I am not too bothered by it because I believe my grades are doing alright. I think

I am held back by the idea that what I'm doing is ok because I am comfortable, but realistically I'm incapable of being my ideal self with that mindset.